

DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

CSE0001 – Project Report

Name	Devang Atiyolil
Registration No.	24BCE11332
Branch	CSE core
Year	Second Year B.Tech
Course Code	CSE0001 – Digital Literacy
Date of Submission	31 March 2026
Institution	VIT Bhopal University

Introduction

This project report documents my work as a Student Digital Ambassador for VIT Bhopal University, completed as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course. The assignment challenged me to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio that covers five key areas: creating visual awareness resources, establishing a professional online presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practising professional digital communication, and understanding cybercrime and online safety.

Each task in this portfolio corresponds to one module of the course. The work is compiled in a single GitHub repository, and this report explains what I built, which tools I used, and what I learned along the way. No prior coding knowledge was required — every tool used is free and browser-based, which itself demonstrated the accessibility of digital skills for all students.

The overarching goal of this portfolio is not merely academic: it is meant to be a living resource that I can build upon throughout my four years at VIT Bhopal, and one that I can share with peers, faculty, and future employers.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used & Design Overview

For this task, I used Canva, a free browser-based design tool available at canva.com. Canva was chosen because it provides a large library of infographic templates and drag-and-drop editing, making it accessible to students without a graphic design background. The final output is a one-page visual infographic titled 'Your Digital Literacy Guide.'

The infographic covers three topics: (1) What Digital Literacy Is — explaining it as the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technologies; (2) Useful Digital Tools for Students — including Google Workspace, GitHub, Canva, and coding platforms like HackerRank; and (3) Safe Internet Practices — covering strong passwords, two-factor authentication, recognising phishing attempts, and protecting personal data online.

The design uses a clean blue-and-white colour scheme with icons and short text blocks to make the information easy to scan at a glance.

Reflection

I found the layout spacing to be the most challenging part of this task. Fitting three distinct topic areas onto a single page without making it look cluttered required several iterations. What I found most interesting was discovering how many free, professional-quality templates are available on Canva — I had assumed design tools would require paid subscriptions or technical skills. The experience highlighted how accessible creative digital work has become for students.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Set Up

For this task, I created or updated profiles on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each platform serves a distinct professional purpose in the digital ecosystem of technology and academia.

- GitHub (github.com): A version control and code hosting platform used by developers worldwide. I created a profile README repository (a special repository named after my username) containing my name, branch, year of study, and a brief statement about what I hope to learn. GitHub will serve as my primary portfolio for all coding projects throughout my degree.
- LinkedIn (linkedin.com): A professional networking platform used by employers, recruiters, and internship coordinators. I completed my Education section with my current degree (B.Tech), institution (VIT Bhopal University), and expected graduation year. LinkedIn will be essential when applying for internships from Year 2 onwards.
- Kaggle (kaggle.com): A data science and machine learning community platform. I created an account to access free datasets and competitions. Even as a first-year student, Kaggle exposes me to real data science workflows and community notebooks.

Future Plans

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to host every significant project and assignment, making it a living portfolio of my technical growth. On LinkedIn, I intend to add certifications, internships, and projects as I complete them. Kaggle will be used to practice data analysis and eventually participate in competitions, which are recognised by employers. Having set up these profiles in Year 1 means I am building a professional presence from day one, rather than scrambling to create one just before placements.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A – Coding Practice

For Part A, I chose HackerRank (hackerrank.com) as my coding practice platform. I created an account and completed the 'Solve Me First' beginner challenge in the Algorithms track, which introduced me to reading input, performing a basic computation, and printing output. The challenge was straightforward but helped me understand the format that competitive programming platforms use.

HackerRank also offers structured skill certifications, which will become useful when applying for internships in Year 2 and Year 3. A HackerRank certificate in Python or SQL, earned through a timed assessment, is recognised by many companies as a valid proof of skill.

Part B – Google Workspace Collaboration

For Part B, I created a Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for First-Year Students.' The form contains five questions:

- What does the term 'Digital Literacy' mean? (Multiple choice with four options)
- Which of the following is NOT a safe password practice? (Multiple choice)
- Name one platform you would use to share coding projects professionally. (Short answer)
- What is phishing? (Multiple choice with four options)
- What should you do before clicking a link in an email from an unknown sender? (Short answer)

The form is linked to a Google Sheet that automatically collects responses. This would allow me, as a Digital Ambassador, to track how many students participated and analyse common misconceptions about digital literacy.

Reflection

These tools are directly useful academically. HackerRank will be part of my weekly practice routine. The Google Form exercise taught me how easily a teacher can deploy a quiz to hundreds of students — a skill I can use for group projects and event feedback collection. The combination of both tools showed me how cloud-based platforms remove the friction from learning and collaboration.

Task 4 – Professional Email Etiquette

Professional Emails

For Part A, I wrote two professional emails (included as separate files in the task-4-email-etiquette/ folder of the repository). The first email is a polite, well-structured request for an assignment deadline extension sent to a professor. The second is a cold outreach email expressing interest in a summer internship, sent to an internship coordinator at a company.

Both emails follow the key principles of professional email communication: a clear and descriptive subject line, a formal greeting using the recipient's title and name, a concise and well-structured body paragraph, a courteous close, and a professional sign-off with a full name.

Communication Scenario

One situation where poor digital communication caused real problems involves a student who posted a frustrated, informal message about a faculty member on a public WhatsApp group. The message, intended for a small circle of friends, was shared widely and eventually reached the faculty member and the institution's administration. The student faced a formal inquiry and had the post affected their placement eligibility review. The root cause was a failure to separate personal venting from professional digital spaces. What could have been done differently: the student could have spoken to a counsellor or a trusted friend in a private, offline conversation, or written the frustration in a private journal. A useful rule of thumb is to ask, 'Would I be comfortable if my HOD or future employer saw this?' before posting anything publicly online.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

Case Study Summary: UPI/Online Payment Fraud

For Task 5, I chose UPI/Online Payment Fraud as my cybercrime type (the full case study is available in [task-5-cybercrime/casestudy.md](#)). The case study follows a fictional first-year engineering student named Arjun who falls victim to a 'collect request' scam. He is contacted by someone posing as a fellow student on WhatsApp who asks him to approve a small UPI collect request, claiming it is a 'test transaction' to verify a payment group. Arjun approves it, believing he is receiving money. Instead, he authorises a payment out of his account.

The case study details how the scam typically unfolds: the fraudster uses social engineering to create urgency and trust, exploits the victim's unfamiliarity with the difference between 'send' and 'collect' requests on UPI apps, and often repeats the scam with escalating amounts once the victim has approved the first transaction.

Reflection

The most surprising thing I discovered while researching this topic was how sophisticated social engineering attacks have become — many do not involve any technical hacking at all. The victim is manipulated into taking an action they believe is safe. I also found it surprising that thousands of cybercrime cases in India involve UPI fraud, yet awareness among college students remains low.

One habit I will personally change as a result of this research: I will never approve a UPI collect request from someone I have not verified through a second communication channel (for example, calling them directly on a known number). The reporting channel I will keep saved is the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and the 24x7 helpline number 1930.

Conclusion

This Digital Literacy Portfolio project has been one of the most practical assignments I have completed. Unlike purely theoretical coursework, every task produced something tangible: a public GitHub repository, active professional profiles, a live Google Form, polished email drafts, and a cybercrime awareness resource.

The most important takeaway for me is that digital skills are not optional extras — they are foundational to success in any career. A student who graduates with strong digital communication habits, a maintained professional profile, and an understanding of online safety is significantly better prepared than one who has not thought about these areas. I intend to continue building on this portfolio throughout my degree.

References

- Canva design tool: canva.com
- GitHub: github.com
- LinkedIn: linkedin.com
- Kaggle: kaggle.com
- HackerRank: hackerrank.com
- Google Forms: forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal: cybercrime.gov.in
- Cybercrime Helpline: 1930 (24x7, Government of India)
- VITyarthi E-Learning Platform – CSE0001 Course Material